MINE IN A BOX™

Managing Strategy

Handbook

Systems that make good decisions inevitable.



Contents

1. Welcome to the program 3

2. What Managing Strategy is 3

3. Why it is different 3

4. How the model works 4

5. The steps 5

Step A. The executive working session: set the plan 6

Step B. Take it to site: build the Tactics, Plans and Actions 8

Step C. Define the meetings and set their dates 10

Step D. Run the head office meetings 11

Head office IN meeting (weekly) 11

Head office ON meeting (monthly) 13

Step E. Implement the site meetings 16

Site IN meeting: Weekly Site Review 16

Site ON meeting: Monthly Site Review 18

Terms and acronyms 21

References 21

How to use this handbook

Sections 1 to 4 explain the model and why it works. Section 5 takes you through the five steps in order. Each step lists the decisions to make, the meetings to run and the tool to use, with a worked example. The tools named in this handbook (Tools 1 to 4 and the self-assessment) are in the separate Managing Strategy Workbook, issued before Step A. Where your site is led by a General Manager or Mine Manager rather than a Project Manager, read Project Manager as the site's most senior leader.

A The executive working session: set the plan

B Take it to site: build the Tactics, Plans and Actions

C Define the meetings and set their dates

D Run the head office meetings

E Implement the site meetings

1. Welcome to the program

Managing Strategy joins the plan at head office to the work on site. The executive sets where the business is going. Each site builds how it will get there. Four meetings keep the two joined, every week and every month.

The program takes your business through five steps. In the first one, your executive team, General Managers, Operations Managers and Project Managers sit down together and set the plan. By the last one, every site and head office is running its IN and ON meetings on the plan.

> **Management is the structuring of work and decisions so that performance remains predictable under pressure.**
>
> – Dawid Falck

2. What Managing Strategy is

Managing Strategy is the strategy part of Operational Architecture. It has three parts:

PART	WHAT IT IS
The plan	GOSTPA, the plan in six layers (section 4).
The owners	Every part of the plan has one owner and one place where it may be changed.
The meetings	Four meetings: an IN meeting at head office, weekly, and an ON meeting at head office, monthly; and an IN and an ON meeting at each site. IN runs the business. ON improves it.

The four meetings sit on top of the site's existing daily and planning meetings (Daily Site Review, weekly planning, Monthly Planning Meeting).

3. Why it is different

Decisions are placed before the work. A business performs predictably when its decisions are made before the work, by the right person, in the right forum. Each layer of the plan is decided by the level whose time horizon matches it. A decision made at the wrong level either waits for a meeting that comes too late, or is made again every week by people who cannot see the whole picture.

It runs on a rhythm of work, not on reports. Weekly IN meetings keep the week on plan. ON meetings look at the business itself through the core questions (section 4): Are our people safe? Are we running a quality business? Are we making money, and can we make more? Are our people happy? Then they ask whether the Strategies are delivering. Each meeting exists to make a set of decisions, and every decision leaves with an owner and a date.

It trains managers. It does not check compliance. Each meeting has a coaching card: ten lines that say what good looks like, marked Yes or No. The people who run the meeting mark themselves against it. A No is the next thing to coach, not a fault to report. The card checks that the work was done, not that a form was filled in. The chair's manager coaches against the card: the CEO coaches the COO at the head office meetings, the COO coaches the Project Managers at the site meetings, and our facilitators coach during deployment.

4. How the model works

GOSTPA

LAYER	WHAT IT IS	WHO SETS IT	WHEN IT CHANGES
G · Goal	What business we are really running, in one sentence anyone can repeat.	The executive team	Rarely, and only with Board approval
O · Objectives	No more than five things that must be true for the Goal to be met. Each has a number, a date and one executive owner.	The executive team	Only with Board approval, and the cause is logged
S · Strategies	How the business will reach each Objective. Each has one owner and the value it should create.	The executive team, with the General Managers, Operations Managers and Project Managers in the room	Reviewed for work every month (keep, fix, merge, stop); changed on value at the quarterly review
T · Tactics	The approach the site is taking now to deliver a Strategy. Each has a trigger that says it is not working.	The site leadership team	When its trigger fires, and at the quarterly review
P · Plans	The scheduled work: who, what, where and when.	Each site and department	Weekly
A · Actions	What is done this week and this shift, with an owner and a date.	Each site and department	Every shift

THE RULE. A plan corrects itself at the speed of the layer that is wrong. An Action is fixed tonight. A Plan is fixed this week. A Tactic is fixed at the site ON meeting. An Objective is changed only with Board approval.

The evidence behind the model

The model is built on a small number of well-tested ideas.

- **Businesses grow in steps (Greiner 1972, revised 1998).** Greiner described five phases of growth. Each phase ends at a turning point that the old way of managing cannot get past. A mid-tier miner usually reaches the crisis of control: the sites run their own month, and head office cannot see whether those months add up to the plan. The fix is a plan that cascades and a rhythm of meetings, not another report.
- **The time horizon of a decision tells you who should make it (Jaques 1989; Macdonald, Burke and Stewart 2018).** Roles differ by the time span of their decisions. The model applies this: an Action is settled in hours, a Plan in a week, a Tactic in a month and an Objective over years, and GOSTPA gives each layer to the level that works on that horizon.
- **Clear, hard goals with feedback work (Locke and Latham 2002; Doran 1981).** Specific, stretching goals with regular feedback beat "do your best". That is why each Objective has a number, a date and one owner. No more than five is the model's own design choice, to keep attention on what matters most.
- **Keep running the business apart from changing it (Kaplan and Norton 2008).** When operating reviews and strategy reviews share one meeting, the day's crisis pushes strategy out. That is why IN and ON are separate meetings.
- **Track the value, not only the work (Mankins and Steele 2005).** On average, strategies deliver about 63% of the value they promise, and few companies track the gap. That is why every Strategy is checked each quarter in volume and dollars.

Strategies are tracked on two questions:

QUESTION	CHECKED	WHERE
Is the work being done?	Monthly	Site ON meeting, then head office ON
Is it creating value? Measured in volume and dollars.	Quarterly review	Site ON meeting, then head office ON

The core questions. Every ON meeting, at site and at head office, is built on the same questions, asked in this order: 1. Are our people safe? 2. Are we running a quality business? 3. Are we making money, and can we make more? 4. Are our people happy?



5. The steps

Step A. The executive working session: set the plan

Step B. Take it to site: build the Tactics, Plans and Actions

Step C. Define the meetings and set their dates

Step D. Run the head office meetings

Step E. Implement the site meetings

The worked examples in this section follow one mining example and use illustrative numbers. Their weeks are programme weeks, counted from the start of the program; weeks 1 to 4 in the meeting calendar are the weeks of each month. Every tool named here is in the separate Managing Strategy Workbook. You can also download the blank tools from Strategy Sam. [CONFIRM: how far apart steps A to E typically run, and who facilitates steps B to E.]

A The executive working session: set the plan

The executive working session is where the plan is set. It is facilitated by The Decision Architecture Group and usually takes half a day. The lead facilitator opens by explaining why the session is being held and how it will run. By the end, the executive team has agreed what business it is running, what must be true to succeed, and how each Objective will be reached, with one owner for each. The General Managers, Operations Managers and Project Managers hear the plan first-hand and say what their sites can deliver. After the session, the Project Managers take the plan to their sites to build the Tactics, Plans and Actions (step B).

Outcome: The leaders leave with the Goal, up to five Objectives and the Strategies agreed, each with one owner, and the four meeting agendas agreed.

- **Owner:** CEO
- **Attends:** COO, the executive team, General Managers, Operations Managers and Project Managers

Run sheet (half day)

TIME (H:MM)	WHAT IS COVERED	OUTPUT
0:00 to 0:20	Opening: the purpose of the session and how it will run	Everyone clear on what will be decided today
0:20 to 0:50	Where we are now: the growth staircase and the maturity matrix, from the self-assessments	Decision 1: where the business sits, on evidence
0:50 to 1:20	The Goal: what business we are really running	Decision 2: one sentence anyone can repeat
1:20 to 2:10	The Objectives: no more than five, each with a number, a date and one executive owner	Decision 3: up to five Objectives, each with a number, a date and one owner
2:10 to 2:25	Break	
2:25 to 3:25	The Strategies for each Objective, with the sites' view of what they can deliver	Decision 4: each Strategy with one owner and its value in volume and dollars
3:25 to 3:50	The four meeting agendas	Decision 5: agreed, with any changes to fit the business
3:50 to 4:00	Close: what each person does next, and the dates for step B	Actions with owners and dates

G
Goal: the business we are really running

O
Objectives: up to five, each with a number, date and owner

S
Strategies: how each Objective is reached

T
Tactics: the site's approach, with a trigger

P
Plans: who, what, where and when

A
Actions: this week, with an owner and a date

Decisions this session must make (tick each)

#	DECISION	DONE
1	Where the business sits on the growth staircase and the maturity matrix, on evidence	☐
2	The Goal: one sentence anyone in the business can repeat	☐
3	The Objectives: no more than five, each with a number, a date and one executive owner	☐
4	The Strategies for each Objective, each with one owner and the value it should create, in volume and dollars	☐
5	The four meeting agendas (steps D and E): agreed, with any changes to fit the business	☐

THE RULES. An Objective without a number, a date and an owner is not set. The PMs are in the room to speak, not to listen. What a site says it cannot deliver is recorded, with the reason.

WHEN YOU DO THIS, USE: Workbook Tool 1, Where we are now (completed before the session), and Tool 2, the Goal, Objectives and Strategies builder.

KEY QUESTION: What business are we really running, and what must be true for the Goal to be delivered?

The self-assessment is Workbook Tool 1, Where we are now: the growth staircase, the maturity matrix and the meetings run today. Each person attending completes it on their own before the session; the answers are used for Decision 1.

Bring to the session

WHAT	WHO
The self-assessment, completed	Each person attending
Last year against plan, in PAVA (plan, actual, variance, action), with causes	The executive team
Each site's view of what it can deliver	Project Managers

WORKED EXAMPLE

Tool 1c. The meetings we run now (two rows)

MEETING	WHERE	OWNER	HOW OFTEN, HOW LONG	WHAT IT DECIDES	IN OR ON?	ADDS VALUE?	KEEP, CHANGE OR STOP
Monday operations meeting	Head office	COO	Weekly, 2.5 hours	Everything at once: the week, safety, cost, projects	Both	N	Change: split into an IN and an ON meeting
Monthly site report	Each site	Project Manager	Monthly, written	Nothing; it is read, not answered	Neither	N	Stop: replaced by the site ON meeting

Tool 2. The Goal: We mine safely, at a cost our clients will pay, and every site delivers the tonnes it promised.

Tool 2. The Objectives (one row)

#	OBJECTIVE	NUMBER	DATE	EXECUTIVE OWNER	LOAD-BEARING?
O2	Orderly operations and fiscal discipline	Equipment damage cost down from $4.2M to $3.0M a year	30 June next year	COO	Yes: unit cost and fleet availability fail with it

Tool 2. The Strategies (one row)

#	STRATEGY	SERVES	OWNER	VALUE: VOLUME	VALUE: $	SITES
S3	Reduce accident damage to equipment	O2	General Manager	120 fewer tyres a year; truck availability up 2%	$1.2M a year (tyres and related damage)	All sites

B Take it to site: build the Tactics, Plans and Actions

Step B turns the head office plan into site work. The Project Manager leads it at each site, guided by the General Manager or Operations Manager, with the site leadership team in the room. When it is done well, every Strategy that applies to the site has Tactics with an owner and a trigger, every Tactic has scheduled Plans, and this week's Actions have an owner and a date. The finished plan is what the site's meetings will run on, so step C sets those meetings next.

Outcome: Each site leaves with its Tactics, Plans and Actions built under the agreed Strategies. What it cannot deliver goes back to the next head office ON meeting as an ask, with the reason.

- **Owner:** Project Manager, guided by the General Manager or Operations Manager
- **Attends:** the site leadership team: Mine Manager, Department Managers, Superintendents, Commercial
- **Facilitated by:** [CONFIRM facilitator]
- **When:** after step A. [CONFIRM duration]

Decisions this session must make (tick each)

#	DECISION	DONE
1	What each Strategy asks of this site: agreed	☐
2	What the site cannot deliver, with the reason and what it would take	☐
3	The Tactics for each Strategy, each with one owner and a trigger that says it is not working	☐
4	The Plans: who, what, where and when	☐
5	The Actions: each with an owner and a date	☐

KEY QUESTION: How will this site deliver the Strategies, on this ground, with this fleet and these people?

Bring to the session

WHAT	WHO
The Tool 2 output: the Objectives and Strategies	Project Manager
The site's constraints	Mine Manager, Commercial
The roster and the fleet	Superintendents

THE RULES. A Tactic without a trigger is not a Tactic. An Action without an owner and a date is not an action.

WHEN YOU DO THIS, USE: Workbook Tool 3, the site Tactics, Plans and Actions builder.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Tool 3. The Tactics

#	TACTIC	DELIVERS	OWNER	TRIGGER THAT SAYS IT IS NOT WORKING
T1	Protect tyres: clean haul roads, clear the dig-face toe, and train crews out of dry turning	S3	Mine Manager	More than 6 tyres cut or pulled early in a month, two months running
T2	Road design: fix the hairpins, and the bunds too close to the turn	S3	Technical Services Superintendent	Any truck contact with a bund on a turn, or the north ramp not rebuilt by 30 September this year

Tool 3. The Plans

#	WHAT	DELIVERS	WHO	WHERE	WHEN
P1	Educate the crews: what damages a tyre and what one costs	T1	Mining Superintendent	Pre-start, all four crews	Programme weeks 1 and 2
P2	Clean up loose rocks on roads, ramps and dumps	T1	Shift Supervisors	All haul roads	Every shift
P3	Stop driving into stones at the dig face toe: the loader clears the toe before each truck	T1	Load and Haul Superintendent	Every dig face	From programme week 2
P4	Vary the haul line so trucks don't wear a divot	T1	Shift Supervisors	Main haul road	Every shift
P5	Stop dry turning: steer only while rolling	T1	Trainer	All trucks and loaders	Programme weeks 1 to 4
P6	Redesign the two hairpins and move the bunds back from the turn	T2	Mine Planning Engineer	North ramp	Design by 31 August this year

Tool 3. The Actions (three rows)

#	ACTION	FOR	OWNER	DUE	DONE
A1	Tyre damage talk at pre-start, A and B crews	P1	Shift Supervisor, A crew	Programme week 1, Thursday	
A2	Grader on the main haul road and ramp each shift	P2	Shift Supervisor, day shift	Daily from programme week 1	
A3	Survey the north ramp turns and mark the bund set-back	P6	Surveyor	Programme week 6, Friday	

C Define the meetings and set their dates

Step C fixes when every meeting happens, so the plan is reviewed on a set rhythm rather than when someone finds time. The Project Managers do it with the COO. Done well, every meeting has an owner, a day, a time and a first date, and the site and head office meetings follow on from each other in the right order. Once the calendar is set, the meetings start (steps D and E).

Outcome: Every head office and site meeting has an owner, a day, a time and a start date, and they fit together in one calendar.

Step A agreed the four agendas; step C only fits the meeting times to the roster. The order of the meetings and the decisions they make do not change.

First month. The site IN meetings and the head office IN meeting start in the same week. The first site ON meeting (week 4) runs before the first head office ON meeting, which then reads every site's month. Steps D and E describe the meetings in a reading order, not a start order.

The timing rules

- Each site holds its IN meeting in weeks 1 to 3. Its ON meeting is in week 4.
- Each site's pack and S·T·P·A return go up within 3 days of its ON meeting.
- Head office's answers to each site's asks go back within 3 days, before the site's Monthly Planning Meeting.
- The head office IN meeting is weekly. The head office ON meeting is monthly, in week 1, after the site ON meetings.
- The quarterly review: each site's ON meeting in the last month of each quarter, then the head office ON meeting in week 1 of the next month. Strategies are reviewed for work every month (keep, fix, merge, stop) and changed on value at the quarterly review.

WHEN YOU DO THIS, USE: Workbook Tool 4, the meeting calendar.

Worked example: the monthly rhythm at a glance (Tool 4)

MEETING	OWNER	DAY	TIME	LENGTH	FIRST DATE	WEEK 1	WEEK 2	WEEK 3	WEEK 4
Head office IN	COO	Friday	08:00	60 min	Month 1, week 1	●	●	●	●
Head office ON	CEO or COO	Tuesday	09:00	3 hours	Month 2, week 1	●			
Site IN: North Pit	Superintendent or Mine Manager	Wednesday	07:00	60 min	Month 1, week 1	●	●	●	
Site ON: North Pit	Project Manager	Wednesday	07:00	3 hours	Month 1, week 4				●

Head office ON reads every site's month in week 1. Site ON is in week 4, when it replaces that week's Site IN.

D Run the head office meetings

Step D describes the two head office meetings. The weekly IN meeting runs the business's week: what slipped, clashes between sites and where resources go. The monthly ON meeting looks at the business itself: the core questions, whether the Strategies are delivering the Objectives, and what changes. The COO chairs the IN meeting; the CEO or COO chairs the ON meeting. Done well, the IN meeting never runs past the hour, and every site leaves the ON meeting with its asks answered within 3 days.

Head office IN meeting (weekly)

Outcome: The business's week is decided in one hour. Task slips and issues are dealt with, workloads are balanced, clashes between sites are settled, resources are moved, and one list of priorities lands before the sites plan their week.

- **Owner:** COO, who chairs it
- **Attends:** Project Managers (each presents their own site's week), General Managers, Operations Managers, and the executive team members whose areas are affected; the CEO when possible
- **When:** Weekly, Friday. 60 minutes, hard stop.
- **Feeds:** each site's weekly planning, and the head office ON meeting (items flagged)

Decisions this meeting must make (tick each)

#	DECISION	DONE
1	Each task slip and issue: recovered, with an owner and a date	☐
2	Clashes between sites (shared gear, people, contractors, laydown), settled this week	☐
3	Resource moves between sites, and workloads rebalanced, with the number each protects	☐
4	Next week's priorities: one list, in order	☐
5	What is flagged for the head office ON meeting (flagged, not opened)	☐

KEY QUESTION: What slipped this week, and where do the business's people and resources go next week?

Bring to the meeting

WHAT	WHO
Each site's week from its Weekly Site Review: task slips, issues, what it needs (night before)	Project Managers
Current workloads: crews, contractors and key people, by site	General Managers, Operations Managers
Shared resources: gear, people, contractors, laydown	COO
Action register: last week's actions, done or not	Administrator

Agenda (60 minutes)

MIN	ITEM	LEAD	OUTPUT
5	Last week's actions: done or not, and why	Chair	Register updated
18	Each site's week, two minutes each (scale to the number of sites): task slips and issues, not stories	Project Managers	What each site needs
8	Current workloads: who is over and who has room	Chair	Workloads rebalanced
15	Clashes between sites and resource moves decided	Chair	Each settled, with the number it protects
10	Next week's priorities	Chair	One list, with owners and dates
4	Flagged for ON	Chair	Items for the head office ON meeting

RULE: what cannot be settled in the hour goes to the head office ON meeting with an owner. Nothing is parked without a date.

Coaching card (Yes / No)

#	WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE	Y/N
1	Starts and ends inside 60 minutes	☐
2	Every site's week is in by the night before	☐
3	Last week's actions read first: done or not, and why	☐
4	Each site's week received in two minutes: task slips and issues, not judged again	☐
5	Every task slip and issue leaves with an owner and a date	☐
6	Every clash between sites leaves settled, with the number it protects	☐
7	Every resource move or workload change leaves with the number it protects	☐
8	Next week's priorities leave as one list, before the sites plan their week	☐
9	No strategy, trend or financial analysis; items for ON are flagged, not opened	☐
10	People can admit mistakes and ask questions without being put down	☐

Actions required from any No: _____ Owner: _____ By: _____

Head office ON meeting (monthly)

Outcome: The executive leaves knowing how the business's month went, whether the Strategies are delivering the Objectives, what changes, and what each site gets back. Every site ask is answered.

- **Owner:** CEO or COO, depending on how the organisation is set up
- **Attends:** the executive team (each one an Objective owner), Finance, General Managers, Operations Managers; Project Managers present their own site
- **When:** Monthly, week 1, after the site ON meetings. 3 hours.
- **Feeds:** every site's next Monthly Planning Meeting. The return goes down within 3 days.

KEY QUESTION: How did the business's month go, are our Strategies delivering the Objectives, and what do we change?

Decisions this meeting must make (tick each)

#	DECISION	DONE
1	Each Objective: on track, at risk or off track, on trend	☐
2	The core questions answered for the business, site against site, on trend	☐
3	Each Strategy: is its work being done (every month), and is it creating value (every quarter, in volume and dollars)?	☐
4	Each Strategy: keep, fix, merge or stop	☐
5	Where people, capital or support move, and why	☐
6	Every site ask answered: yes, no or a date	☐
7	Any Objective change to put to the Board, with its cause	☐
8	One message for every site	☐

Bring to the meeting

WHAT	WHO
Action register and asks register	Administrator
The Objectives at a glance: number, date, trend	Analyst
Every site's pack and S·T·P·A return: the same numbers as the site ON, side by side for every site, plus a business total, last 6 months on trend	Project Managers, Analyst
The GOSTPA plan: each Strategy's owner and Tactics, work done or not	Strategy owners
At the quarterly review: each Strategy's value, in volume and dollars, against plan	Objective owners, Finance

Agenda (3 hours)

MIN	ITEM	LEAD	OUTPUT
10	Last month's actions and open asks: done or not, what moved	Chair	Register updated
15	The Objectives at a glance, on trend	Chair	Objectives off track chosen for decision
20	1. Are our people safe? Any high-potential incident or failed critical control, any site	Chair	Safety actions across sites
35	2. Are we running a quality business? Site against site, on trend, customers included	General Managers, with Project Managers	Systems to fix, with owners
25	3. Are we making money, and can we make more? PAVA by site, plus a business total	Finance, with Project Managers	Re-forecast; where more can be made
10	4. Are our people happy?	General Managers	Actions
40	The Strategies: is the work being done? (Each quarter: what value did it create, in volume and dollars?)	Objective owners	Each Strategy kept, fixed, merged or stopped
15	Decisions: resources moved; any Objective change for the Board	Chair	Decisions logged, with cause
10	Close: every site ask answered, the message to sites	Chair	Return to sites, dated

RULE: an Objective is changed only with Board approval, and the cause is logged. Nothing is parked without a date.

WHEN YOU DO THIS, USE: Workbook Tool 2, the Goal, Objectives and Strategies builder (its strategy tracker), and the coaching card on page 15.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Tool 2. The strategy tracker (first quarter shown)

#	SITE	M1	M2	M3	Q1 VALUE (VOL / $)
S3	North Pit	Y	N	Y	34 fewer tyres / $310k (tyres and related damage)
S3	South Pit	Y	Y	Y	12 fewer tyres / $110k (tyres and related damage)

North Pit's N in month 2: the north ramp survey (A3) slipped from programme week 6 to programme week 9. Verdict at the head office ON meeting: keep S3, fix the slip.

Coaching card (Yes / No)

#	WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE	Y/N
1	Starts and ends on time	☐
2	Every Objective shown on its number and date, on trend	☐
3	Every site pack read before the meeting, side by side, with a business total	☐
4	The core questions answered in order, with numbers, on trend	☐
5	Each Strategy shows, with evidence, whether its work is being done	☐
6	Each quarter, every Strategy's value is shown in volume and dollars, against plan (N/A outside quarter-end)	☐
7	Every Strategy leaves with keep, fix, merge or stop	☐
8	Every site ask answered: yes, no or a date	☐
9	The return reaches every site within 3 days	☐
10	People can admit mistakes and ask questions without being put down	☐

Actions required from any No: _____ Owner: _____ By: _____

E Implement the site meetings

Step E brings the same rhythm to each site. In weeks 1 to 3, the site meeting is the IN meeting, the Weekly Site Review: it judges the week and gives every threat to next week an owner. The Superintendent leads it; where the site has a Mine Manager, the Mine Manager leads and the Superintendent attends. In week 4, the site meeting is the ON meeting, the Monthly Site Review, led by the Project Manager. It runs two hours longer and looks at trends, plans and the Strategies, structured around the core questions. Done well, the site's pack and S·T·P·A return reach head office within 3 days, ready for the next head office ON meeting, and the loop runs again each month.

Site IN meeting: Weekly Site Review

Outcome: The site leaders leave with this week's numbers judged and every threat to next week given an owner. What the site cannot fix leaves named, with an owner and a forum.

- **Owner:** Superintendent. Where the site has a Mine Manager, the Mine Manager leads and the Superintendent attends.
- **Attends:** Project Manager, Department Managers and Superintendents, Planning, Safety lead, Maintenance, HSEC, HR, Technical Services
- **When:** Weekly, weeks 1 to 3. 60 minutes. In week 4 it becomes the first hour of the site ON meeting.
- **Feeds:** the head office IN meeting (the site's week, by the night before) and the site ON meeting

KEY QUESTION: Where did this week land, and what is coming that could impact next week?

Decisions this meeting must make (tick each)

#	DECISION	DONE
1	Each department's response: recovery and prevention actions, with owners and dates	☐
2	Next week's threats: each given an owner, with what they will do and by when	☐
3	What changes in next week's plan, roster or maintenance windows	☐
4	The site's priorities: one list (the action register), reviewed by everyone, with one owner and a date on every item	☐
5	What goes up: each item with an owner and a forum	☐

Bring to the meeting

WHAT	WHO
Each department's week, one page	Department Managers
Task adherence: planned tasks done against planned	Planning
This week's production numbers, by department, in PAVA	Department Managers
Weak signals, trended	Safety lead
Maintenance: schedule compliance, availability, backlog, MTBF	Maintenance
The coming week: weather, crew numbers and churn, the recruitment pipeline	Planning, HR

Agenda (60 minutes)

MIN	ITEM	LEAD	OUTPUT
5	Weak signals: what are we repeatedly getting away with?	Safety lead	The pattern named
10	Task adherence: what slipped, and why	Department Managers	Causes named
10	This week's numbers, two minutes per department, in PAVA	Department Managers	Week judged
5	Maintenance: schedule compliance, availability, backlog, MTBF	Maintenance	Actions, with owners
10	What is coming: weather, crews, recruitment	Owner	Threats listed
10	Impact on next week's shifts	Owner	Each threat given an owner
10	What leaves site	Owner	Owner, forum and date for each

RULE: a Strategy question raised here belongs to the site ON meeting. An operational problem raised at ON belongs to tomorrow's Daily Site Review.

Coaching card (Yes / No)

#	WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE	Y/N
1	Starts and ends on time	☐
2	Safety trended first: what the site keeps getting away with is examined as a pattern	☐
3	Task adherence and production reviewed against the plan, in PAVA, with delay causes	☐
4	Maintenance reviews schedule compliance, availability, backlog and MTBF, with actions	☐
5	Every threat to next week leaves with an owner	☐
6	The owner asks for the root cause of each slip	☐
7	The meeting ends with one list of site priorities, each item with an owner and a date	☐
8	Every item that goes up leaves with an owner and a forum	☐
9	Strategy questions are held for the site ON meeting, not opened here	☐
10	People can admit mistakes and ask questions without being put down	☐

Actions required from any No: _____ Owner: _____ By: _____

Site ON meeting: Monthly Site Review

Outcome: The site leaders leave knowing how the month went, what they will change, and what they need from head office. Every change has an owner, a date and a way to check it worked.

- **Owner:** Project Manager
- **Attends:** Mine Manager (where the site has one), Superintendents, Department Managers, Commercial, Tactic owners; the COO or Operations Manager when possible
- **When:** Monthly, week 4, in place of that week's IN meeting. 3 hours: 1 hour IN (the week, led as in weeks 1 to 3), then 2 hours ON.
- **Feeds:** the head office ON meeting in week 1. The site pack and S·T·P·A return go up within 3 days.

KEY QUESTION: Are we delivering the plan, safely, and what are we changing to do better next month?

One system examined. A system is one repeatable way the site works, such as the pre-start or shift change. The site picks next month's system at the close of each ON meeting, from where the coaching card Nos and the top delays point.

Decisions this meeting must make (tick each)

#	DECISION	DONE
1	The site's month: on track, at risk or off track, on trend	☐
2	What we change in how the work is done, with an owner, a date and a check	☐
3	The one system we examined, and the fix	☐
4	Each improvement and capital project: keep, fix or stop	☐
5	Each Strategy: is the work being done? Each quarter: what value it created, in volume and dollars	☐
6	The site's asks for head office, with the evidence	☐
7	One message for the site team	☐

Bring to the meeting

WHAT	WHO
The data above, in PAVA (plan, actual, variance, action)	Department Managers
Coaching card records for the system being examined	Superintendents
Each Tactic: its Plans and Actions, done or not; each quarter, its Strategy's value at this site, in volume and dollars	Tactic owners
Action register and asks from last month	Project Manager

The data (monthly, plan against actual, last 6 months on trend)

QUESTION	NUMBERS	SOURCE
1. Are our people safe?	TRIFR and LTIs, high-potential incidents; field interactions and critical control checks done; hazards reported; speed and fatigue alerts	Safety system
2. Are we running a quality business?	Fleet availability, use and dig/haul rate by fleet; effective hours; top 5 delays (hours); lost tonnes by cause; truck cycle time (queue, load, haul, dump); shift change losses; spatial compliance; tonnes and quality delivered against commitment; ROM and stockpile against target	Fleet management system or shift reports, Commercial
2. Are we running a quality business? (maintenance)	Schedule compliance, backlog (weeks), MTBF, top 5 failures by hours lost	Maintenance system
3. Are we making money, and can we make more?	Total moved (BCM or t), waste and ore/coal split; ore/coal mined and grade or quality; strip ratio; metres drilled; blast-ready inventory (days); unit cost per t or BCM	Fleet management system or shift reports, Finance
4. Are our people happy?	Absence, overtime, turnover; training done against plan	HR, rosters

Start with these 8: total moved · ore/coal mined · spatial compliance · dig rate · fleet availability · fleet use · top 5 delays · unit cost.

Agenda (3 hours)

MIN	ITEM	LEAD	OUTPUT
60	The week (IN): settle it so it does not eat the ON time	Superintendent or Mine Manager	Week decided
10	Last month's actions and asks: done or not, what moved	Project Manager	Register updated
15	1. Are our people safe?	Mine Manager	Safety actions
30	2. Are we running a quality business? Fleet, delays, customers, one system examined	Superintendents	Fix for that system
25	3. Are we making money, and can we make more? PAVA by department, projects	Department Managers	Re-forecast; projects kept, fixed or stopped
5	4. Are our people happy?	Project Manager	Actions
20	The Strategies: is the work being done? (Each quarter: what value did it create?)	Tactic owners	Each Strategy's work and value; Tactics kept or changed on their trigger, and at the quarterly review
15	Close: changes, owners, dates, checks; asks for head office; message	Project Manager	Register, site pack, S·T·P·A return

Coaching card (Yes / No)

#	WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE	Y/N
1	Starts and ends on time, the IN hour included	☐
2	Every number shown in PAVA, on trend, not one month	☐
3	The core questions answered in order, with numbers	☐
4	Delays and lost tonnes explained by cause	☐
5	One system examined on evidence, not opinion	☐
6	Every project and Strategy given a verdict	☐
7	Each quarter, every Strategy's value shown in volume and dollars (N/A outside quarter-end)	☐
8	Every change has an owner, a date and a check	☐
9	Site pack, S·T·P·A return and asks sent to head office within 3 days	☐
10	People can admit mistakes and ask questions without being put down	☐

Actions required from any No: _____ Owner: _____ By: _____

RULE: a project with no measured gain for two months is fixed, given a new owner or stopped. At quarter-end this meeting is the site's part of the quarterly review.

WHEN YOU DO THIS, USE: Workbook Tool 3 (your site's Tactics, Plans and Actions), Tool 2 (the Goal, Objectives and Strategies builder: your site's rows of the strategy tracker) and the coaching card above.

Worked example: North Pit, the month

North Pit's row of the strategy tracker (S3: Y, N, Y; 34 fewer tyres and $310k of tyres and related damage in Q1) is in step D. This is what sat behind the N.

Tool 3. The Actions, as read at the site ON meeting

#	ACTION	FOR	OWNER	DUE	DONE
A1	Tyre damage talk at pre-start, A and B crews	P1	Shift Supervisor, A crew	Programme week 1, Thursday	Y
A2	Grader on the main haul road and ramp each shift	P2	Shift Supervisor, day shift	Daily from programme week 1	Y
A3	Survey the north ramp turns and mark the bund set-back	P6	Surveyor	Programme week 6, Friday (re-dated to programme week 9)	Y (programme week 9, late)

T1's trigger has not fired (4 tyres in month 3, against a limit of 6), so T1 is kept.

Terms and acronyms

GOSTPA: the plan in six layers: Goal, Objectives, Strategies, Tactics, Plans and Actions.

Goal (G): one sentence that says what business we are really running.

Objective (O): one of up to five things that must be true to reach the Goal, each with a number, a date and one owner.

Strategy (S): how the business will reach an Objective, with one owner and the value it should create.

Tactic (T): the approach a site takes now to deliver a Strategy, with a trigger.

Plan (P): scheduled work: who, what, where and when.

Action (A): what is done this week or this shift, with an owner and a date.

Trigger: a limit set in advance that says a Tactic is not working and must change.

Objective owner: the executive accountable for one Objective.

Quarterly review (value check): at quarter-end, the site ON meetings and then the head office ON meeting check the value each Strategy created, in volume and dollars, against plan. Strategies are changed on value here.

Load-bearing: an Objective the Goal fails without.

Core questions: asked in order at every ON meeting: 1. Are our people safe? 2. Are we running a quality business? 3. Are we making money, and can we make more? 4. Are our people happy? Customers are part of question 2.

Operational Architecture: the Mine in a box™ operating system. Managing Operations runs the work on site, shift by shift and week by week; Managing Strategy joins that work to the business's plan.

IN and ON: IN meetings run the business (the week). ON meetings improve it (the month and the Strategies).

S·T·P·A return: one page per Strategy that each site sends up after its ON meeting: Tactics, Plans and Actions, done or not, and each quarter the value created. It is built from the Done column of Workbook Tool 3 and the site's rows of the Tool 2 tracker.

Site pack: the site's numbers for the month (the site ON data table, step E), sent with the return.

PAVA: plan, actual, variance, action: how every number is shown.

Coaching card: ten Yes/No lines that say what a good meeting looks like. A No is the next thing to coach.

Action register: the list of open actions, each with an owner and a date.

Asks register: each site's open asks of head office, each answered yes, no or a date. [CONFIRM: where the action and asks registers live: a Workbook tool or Strategy Sam?]

Growth staircase: the steps a growing business passes through, each ending in a crisis the old way of managing cannot solve.

Maturity matrix: a scale of how well the business manages its work today.

Daily Site Review: the site's daily meeting on the shift's work.

Monthly Planning Meeting: the site meeting that plans the next month.

Strategy Sam: the online home of the program's tools.

TRIFR: total recordable injury frequency rate: recordable injuries per million hours worked.

LTI: lost time injury: an injury that stops a person working their next shift.

High-potential incident: an event that could have caused serious harm.

Critical control: a control that stops a fatal or catastrophic event.

Field interaction: a leader's planned conversation with a crew at the workface.

Weak signal: a small sign of a bigger problem, such as a near miss or a repeated delay.

HSEC: health, safety, environment and community.

MTBF: mean time between failures.

Schedule compliance: planned maintenance done when it was scheduled.

Backlog (weeks): maintenance work waiting, in weeks of crew time.

Availability and use: the share of time equipment is fit to work, and the share of that time it works.

BCM: bank cubic metres: rock measured in the ground, before it is blasted.

ROM: run of mine: ore or coal as mined, before processing.

Strip ratio: waste moved for each tonne of ore or coal.

Dig rate: what a loader loads per hour.

Spatial compliance: how closely mining followed the planned location.

Cycle time: a truck's round trip: queue, load, haul and dump.

Blast-ready inventory: drilled and blasted material ready to dig, in days.

M1, M2, M3 and Q1: months 1 to 3 of a quarter, and the first quarter.

CEO, COO, GM, PM, HR: chief executive officer, chief operating officer, General Manager, Project Manager, human resources.

References

Doran, G.T. (1981). There's a S.M.A.R.T. way to write management's goals and objectives. *Management Review*, 70(11).

Greiner, L.E. (1972, revised 1998). Evolution and revolution as organizations grow. *Harvard Business Review*.

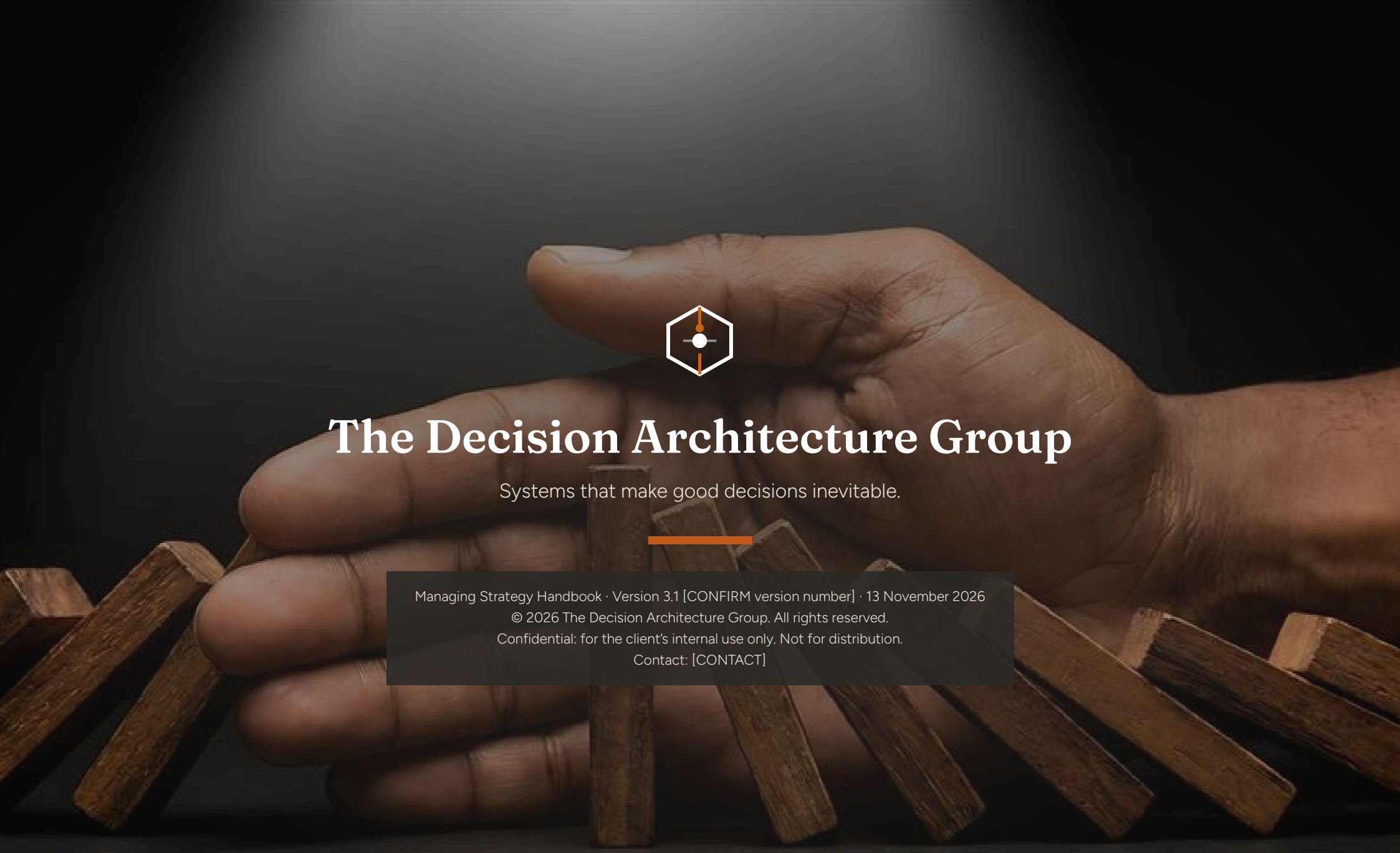
Jaques, E. (1989). *Requisite Organization*. Cason Hall.

Kaplan, R.S. and Norton, D.P. (2008). *The Execution Premium*. Harvard Business Press.

Locke, E.A. and Latham, G.P. (2002). Building a practically useful theory of goal setting and task motivation. *American Psychologist*, 57(9).

Macdonald, I., Burke, C. and Stewart, K. (2018). *Systems Leadership* (2nd edn). Routledge.

Mankins, M.C. and Steele, R. (2005). Turning great strategy into great performance. *Harvard Business Review*.



The Decision Architecture Group

Systems that make good decisions inevitable.

Managing Strategy Handbook · Version 3.1 [CONFIRM version number] · 13 November 2026
© 2026 The Decision Architecture Group. All rights reserved.
Confidential: for the client's internal use only. Not for distribution.
Contact: [CONTACT]